

Republic of Cuba

II-1

Disarmament of the Yemen Civil War

Policy Speech:

I'd like to emphasize the importance of the issue discussed in Resolution 2-1. I must remind you that Saudi Arabia, the United Kingdom, and worst of all, the United States, are all attempting to reinstate the former Yemeni government, which was voted out by the people of Yemen. These acts of unjustified interference will not be forgotten, and these nations must be held accountable and the civil war must end immediately. The objectives of this resolution are well-intentioned, however, it lacks many key details that will strengthen the quality and execution of this vital plan. First, Cuba must clearly state which countries should take action to defeat the Saudi-backed soldiers. Additionally, they must elaborate on how the troops should be deployed, how they will be trained, and their precise objectives. I call upon Cuba and any other motivated nations to please cooperate in determining how might we reduce the vagueness of this paper while improving the timeline and funding.

Key Points:

Positive:

- Attacking NATO countries and allies for their involvement in the Yemen Civil War
- Wants to disarm Saudi-backed government
- Supporting the Iranian Houthi rebels

Negative:

- State which allies should take action to disarm the Saudi-backed government
 - How specifically should the allies go about disarming the government?
- How should the deployed troops be used?
 - Will they go through training?
 - Which weapons will be used?
 - How will they specifically disarm the government?
 - Will there be UN oversight to ensure that no rules are broken?
 - How will the troops be organized?
 - Will the troops cooperate with the Houthi rebels?
- Does Cuba have the necessary funding to destroy all of the confiscated weapons?
 - Cuba's annual military budget is only \$130 million
 - In comparison, Greece, a country with roughly the same population, has an annual military expenditure of \$8.1 billion
- Beginning the project in 2028 is too long of a timeline
 - The goal of completing the project by 2033 means that it will have taken nine years!
 - There must be specifics to shorten this time frame

Policy Speech:

Saudi Arabia wishes to ban loitering munitions, yet they fail to admit that they possess these weapons. Further, loitering munitions prevents civilian casualties and infrastructure damage by reducing collateral damage, using real-time intelligence to verify targets, and offering flexibility to abort a mission, all reasons why we shouldn't ban these weapons. The paper's requested funding of 350 million dollars in addition to an annual 10 million dollars is an exorbitant amount, especially if the budget is only used to pay salaries and for technological development. Furthermore, the World Bank strictly funds humanitarian efforts, so they wouldn't fund this resolution even if it were a viable problem and solution. Lastly, Saudi Arabia fails to detail how loitering munitions would be disarmed in Ukraine's war against Russia, exemplifying the ineffectiveness of this paper, and proving that we cannot support it.

Key Points:

- By their definition of loitering munitions (unmanned aerial drones capable of carrying warheads), Saudi Arabia possesses this type of weapon
 - They can't disarm a weapon that they currently possess
 - Loitering munitions reduce collateral damage, use real-time intelligence to verify targets, and offer flexibility to abort a mission
 - They prevent civilian casualties and infrastructure damage
- The paper fails to detail why loitering munitions must be disarmed
 - Loitering munitions provide nations, including North Korea, with defense mechanisms to defend against potential aggressors
 - Disarming loitering munitions can put nations with weaker militaries that rely on these types of weapons for self-defense at a severe disadvantage
 - The Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons clearly states that prior humanitarian law, such as the Geneva Convention, also applies to autonomous weapons systems, meaning that additional regulation on LAWS is unnecessary and violates previous conventions
 - Further, these conventions have repeatedly been ineffective due to compliance issues, corrupt political motivations, and selective compliance
 - An example of this is how Saudi Arabia uses cluster munitions in the Syria civil war despite international condemnation
 - We shouldn't establish additional treaties and conventions since the pre-existing ones are ineffective and foster conflict and disobedience
- How specifically will DAAWO disarm loitering munitions in Ukraine's war against Russia
- This resolution relies on \$350 million in funding from the World Bank on top of a recurring \$10 million
 - The World Bank provides loans and occasional grants, but not large amounts of funding
 - The World Bank funds humanitarian efforts, not disarmament measures

Policy Speech:

This resolution attempts to divert attention away from the true topic at hand; disarming active war zones. The paper cleverly hopes to remove nuclear weapons from all states that have a city within 1,500 miles of the Imperialist Satellite State, but there's strong evidence stating that the state currently possesses at least 100 nuclear warheads. This would put Palestine and other nations surrounding the Imperialist Satellite State in imminent danger as the state and its allies could conduct a nuclear attack. Since the state hasn't signed the Treaty of the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons, they aren't subject to nuclear inspections, and we, therefore, have no way of determining their nuclear capabilities. Worst of all, since Iran is the only nation within 1,500 miles of the Satellite State with suspected nuclear capabilities, removing their weapons would give Israel unchecked power over the WANA region. This cunning grasp at power should not be taken lightly, and we can't support this resolution at all costs.

Key Points:

- This paper discusses disarming nuclear weapons surrounding an active war zone, which doesn't address the topic at hand
 - The nations involved in the conflict that were mentioned in the paper; Syria, Yemen, and Libya, don't possess nuclear weapons
- Israel is believed to possess 90-400 nuclear warheads
 - Since Israel hasn't signed the Treaty of the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons, they aren't subject to nuclear inspections, and we, therefore, have no way of determining their nuclear capabilities
 - The only country within 1,500 miles of Israel that is suspected of having nuclear powers is Iran
 - Iran is not directly involved in any active conflicts
 - Removing Iran's nuclear capabilities gives Israel unchecked nuclear power
 - This poses an imminent security threat to Palestine, Iran, and other neighboring nations
- The paper hopes to establish a legally binding entity to regulate illegal conventional weapons in the WANA region
 - DISEC doesn't have the legal authority to establish a legally binding entity
 - There are no specific details as to how the illegal conventional weapons will be disarmed
 - The paper hopes to establish punishments for non-compliance, which DISEC also doesn't have the authority to do

Key Points - Disarming Specific Types of Weapons During Armed Conflict (Resolutions 2 & 3)

- States have the fundamental right to self-defense under Article 51 of the UN Charter
 - Banning specific types of weapons is a clear violation of this article since it jeopardizes a nation's right to defend itself and its citizens
 - External restrictions on weapons threaten a nation's autonomy and sovereignty
- The CCW and Non-Proliferation Treaty already regulate the use of various weapons, including weapons of mass destruction and loitering munitions, so additional treaties and regulations are unnecessary
 - Selective enforcement and discrepancies in compliance have caused a multitude of past treaties and regulations, such as the NPT, to be ineffective at achieving their desired result
 - UN regulations often infringe on a nation's sovereignty, so imposing more restrictions threatens a nation's right to self-determination
 - Advanced weapon systems, such as loitering munitions and weapons of mass destruction, often serve as a vital deterrent to prevent aggressive action from adversarial nations
 - Historically, dangerously powerful NATO nations have evaded these regulations while smaller countries have been thrust into danger due to their inability to defend themselves as a result of the regulations
 - Since DISEC can't impose any binding regulations, these restrictions would simply serve as recommendations